Genre annotation project

1. Core Definitions

“Genres are not topics. Topics are determined by content words. A genre is determined by the style of writing, content words are only supporting evidence. ” (Suchomel, 2020)

Genre is a class of documents that share communicative purpose (Kessler et al., 1997).

2. Administrative Information

- **Deadline:** The report should be submitted through Primula no later than **December 2, 2024**.
- **More Work:** If you finish the annotation of sample 1/sample 2 early and want to annotate more, please reach out; the next sample will be sent to you.
- **Shared Samples:** If a sample is assigned to two people, both must download the same file and annotate it separately (we need 2 independent annotations of the same paragraph). Do not split the file into parts.

3. Excel Document Structure & Colour Coding

[

'ocr_errors', 'contents_page', 'publication_info', 'art_author', 'art_title', 'opinionated', 'dialogue', 'caption',

'Academic', 'Administrative', 'Advertisement', 'Announcement', 'Appeal', 'Argumentative', 'Bio', 'Daily_news', 'Fiction', 'Guidance', 'Informational', 'Interactive', 'Invitation', 'Legal', 'PO_report', 'QA' ,

'comment'

]

The annotator is given a table where each row includes a paragraph with its identifiers and empty columns for attributes and genres.

- **GREY Columns (Identifiers):** Metadata (fname, periodical, year, id, volume, issue number, page). **Ignore these** during annotation.
- **WHITE Column (Text):** The paragraph you need to annotate.
- **BLUE Columns (Attributes):** Apply to the text's traits, not its genre. **Assign 1** if the attribute applies, otherwise **leave as 0**. Multiple attributes can apply at the same time. If `contents_page = 1`, all genres must be `0`.
- **ORANGE Columns (Genres):** Hard assignment. **Assign 1** to the single most appropriate genre, and **leave 0** for the others. If no genre applies, leave all as 0 and explain why in the comments.
- **GREEN Column (Comments):** Use this for any notes. **Special Cases:** * If a text is strongly hybrid with no prevailing genre, write: *"hybrid of genre X and Y"*.
    - If the text is a bibliography, assign the same genre as the main text and write *"bibliography"* in the comments.

4. Annotation Procedure

```
timeline
    title Step-by-Step Paragraph Annotation
    Step 1: Context & Reading : Read the target paragraph. :
Check surrounding paragraphs on the page (order is unaltered)
for context clues. : Identify markers and the overall communi
```

```
cative purpose.
    Step 2: Assign Attributes (Blue) : Check for OCR errors o
r structural elements (e.g., titles, contents page). : Does i
t contain opinion? (Assign "opinionated"). : Is it a discussi
on/interview? (Assign "dialogue").
    Step 3: Assign Genre (Orange) : Match the paragraph to on
e candidate genre. : Place a 1 in the corresponding column. :
If no genre fits, leave 0 and clarify in the comments.
```

Tips for Success:

- Take frequent breaks. Trying to stay focused for a long time leads to mistakes.
- Check the full pages to get a better picture of how these genres look in the context of the journal.
- If a sequence of paragraphs falls under the same title, they likely share the same genre, but always verify.
- Do not hesitate to ask questions when in doubt.

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5. Attributes Definitions (Blue Columns)

Attributes describe specific features of the text. **(1 = Yes, 0 = No)**

- **ocr_errors:** Contains optical character recognition errors (misspelled/garbled words). If the text is illegible and no genre can be inferred from context, assign 1 here and 0 to all genres.

> 📎 “sr seooian deeess,,
> 49 ZX^Z /A <9° 00 & 88°
> 19 c® ao-od "R° 20
> 88-8008 /^Z es
> 4990,8" • wog”

- **contents_page:** Corresponds to the table of contents (e.g., "From the contents", "Innehåll"). If 1, all genres must be 0.

E.g., for paragraphs like these one it will be 1:
“From the contents
On the 4th Congress of the German Diabetes Society
16 and 17 May 1969 in Ulm 165”,
”Prof. Dr. med. W. Creutzfeldt
Main task: training diabetics 165”,
”Theory and facts in the changing world of diabetes research 166 Prof. Dr. med. K. Jahnke Diabetes and accidents 171 Friedrich Deich How safe are medicines? 179”,
”Illness pursued for over 300 years 181”,
”Diabetic training 182
Gender of choice 184
Mentally ill students 188”

- **publication_info:** Journal name, editorial info, issue number, or dates (e.g., "DER ALLERGIKER", "8, JAHRGANG"). *Note: Leave page numbers entirely unannotated.*
- **art_author:** Contains names of the article authors (e.g., "Av dr Albert Grönberg"). Assign the same genre as the article it belongs to if you are completely sure.
- **art_title:** The title or subheading of the following article. Assign the same genre as the article it belongs to.
- **caption:** Text identified as a caption under a picture or table (e.g., 'Foto: Lala Aufsberg', 'Fig. 1'). Assign the same genre as the surrounding text if you are completely sure.
- **opinionated:** The text contains an opinion but is not strong/persuasive enough to be classified as the *Argumentative* genre.
- **dialogue:** Multiple people are involved in a discussion (e.g., an interview).

6. Genre Definitions & Decision Trees (Orange Columns)

Genres are categorized below by their primary communicative purpose. Use the decision trees to resolve ambiguities.

Group A: Narrative & Reporting

Texts that focus on telling what happened, describing events, or recounting experiences.

```
flowchart TD
    classDef blue fill:#2374f7,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,c
olor:#fff,font-size:14pt
    classDef orange fill:#fc822b,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2p
x,color:#fff,font-size:14pt
    classDef green fill:#16b522,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,
color:#fff,font-size:12pt

    A[Communicative Purpose: <br>Narrate or Report Events]:::
blue --> B{Domain & Perspective}
    B -->|Neutral, Daily <br>General Events| C(News):::orange
    C -.-> C_desc[What, When, Where of recent events.<br> Oft
en references entities: 'X reports that...']:::green

      B -->|Patient Org <br>Activities| D(PO_report):::orange
    D -.-> D_desc[Chronological narration of PO events,<br> m
eeting minutes, financial reports]:::green

    B -->|Personal Life <br>Experiences| E(Bio):::orange
    E -.-> E_desc[Chronological, 1st/3rd person diaries,<br>
patient experiences, memoirs]:::green

    B -->|Social Services /<br> Govt Initiatives| F(Administr
ative):::orange
```

```
    F -.-> F_desc[Reports on the implementation of<br> health
care programs or govt actions]:::green
```

Group B: Promotional, Persuasive & Announcements

Texts designed to influence the reader's behaviour, opinions, or to formally notify them.

```
flowchart TD
    classDef blue fill:#2374f7,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,c
olor:#fff,font-size:14pt
    classDef orange fill:#fc822b,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2p
x,color:#fff,font-size:14pt
    classDef green fill:#16b522,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,
color:#fff,font-size:12pt
    classDef red fill:#ed2633,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,co
lor:#fff,font-size:12pt

    A[Communicative Purpose: <br>Promote, Persuade, or Notif
y]:::blue --> B{Intent}

    B -->|Express opinion <br>to persuade| C(Argumentativ
e):::orange
    C -.-> C_desc[Subjective, emotional, viewpoint <br>of pub
lisher/author -- e.g., Editorial]:::green

    B -->|Promote Product/Service <br>with Intent to Sell| D
(Advertisement):::orange
    D -.-> D_desc[Subjective, addresses reader, <br>promotes
goods, resorts, etc.]:::green

    B -->|Promote Event <br>with Intent to Sell/Enroll| E(Inv
itation):::orange
    E -.-> E_desc[Invites readers to participate <br>in paid
events -- e.g., cruises]:::green
```

```
    B -->|Request Action <br>No Intent to Sell| F(Appeal):::o
range
    F -.-> F_desc[Call for donations, request political<br> a
ction, seeking pen-pals]:::green

    B -->|Objective Notification <br>No Intent to Sell| G(Ann
ouncement):::orange
    G -.-> G_desc[1st person plural, asks readers to act/regi
ster.<br> Informs of price but doesn't 'advertise']:::green
```

Group C: Descriptive, Informational & Academic

Texts that explain phenomena, present research, or outline laws.

```
flowchart TD
    classDef blue fill:#2374f7,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,c
olor:#fff,font-size:14pt
    classDef orange fill:#fc822b,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2p
x,color:#fff,font-size:14pt
    classDef green fill:#16b522,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,
color:#fff,font-size:12pt

    A[Communicative Purpose: <br>Explain or Describe]:::blue
--> B{Topic & Depth}

    B -->|General Factual <br>Explanation| C(Informationa
l):::orange
    C -.-> C_desc[Neutral point of view, encyclopedic.<br> Ex
plains 'what' something is.]:::green

    B -->|Laws & Regulations| D(Legal):::orange
    D -.-> D_desc[Explains legal terms, conditions, <br>liabi
lities, and enforcement]:::green

    B -->|Academic Research| E(Academic):::orange
```

```
    E -.-> E_desc[Factual reporting of experiments,<br> rich
in specialist/research terms, citations]:::green
```

Deep Dive: Academic

```
flowchart LR
    classDef blue fill:#2374f7,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,c
olor:#fff,font-size:14pt
    classDef orange fill:#fc822b,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2p
x,color:#fff,font-size:14pt
    classDef green fill:#16b522,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,
color:#fff,font-size:12pt

    A(Academic):::blue --> B(Goal):::orange --> B1[Disseminat
e new research <br>or popular science]
    A --> C(Markers):::green
    C --> C1[High density of specialist terms <br>e.g., 'coro
nary angiography']
    C --> C2[Research terms <br>e.g., 'clinical trial', 'meth
od']
    C --> C3[References/Citations <br>of scientific literatur
e]
```

Group D: Instructive, Interactive & Fiction

Texts meant to guide the reader step-by-step, resolve specific doubts, or entertain.

```
flowchart TD
    classDef blue fill:#2374f7,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,c
olor:#fff,font-size:14pt
    classDef orange fill:#fc822b,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2p
x,color:#fff,font-size:14pt
```

```
    classDef green fill:#16b522,stroke:#000,stroke-width:2px,
color:#fff,font-size:12pt

    A[Communicative Purpose: <br>Instruct or Entertain]:::blu
e --> B{Format}

    B -->|Step-by-Step Advice| C(Guidance):::orange
    C -.-> C_desc[Imperative modality 'should/must',<br> reci
pes, manuals, dietary advice]:::green

    B -->|Question & Answer| D(QA):::orange
    D -.-> D_desc[Resolves patient doubts directly.<br> Often
under rubrics like 'Frågan är fri']:::green

    B -->|Games / Puzzles| E(Interactive):::orange
    E -.-> E_desc[Quizzes, crosswords, and solutions]:::green

    B -->|Imaginative Storytelling| F(Fiction):::orange
    F -.-> F_desc[Novels, poems, humor, myths.<br> Emotional
engagement, tropes.]:::green
```

▼ Brief Definitions of all genres

📎 ***Academic***

- ***inform/report*** about research in an accessible way, can contain references to previous research (I would define the communicative goal as both descriptive and reporting here, not clear-cut).

Administrative

- ***reports*** on the implementation of initiatives in social services, healthcare, government; not in the domain of PO

Advertisement

- ***promote*** a product/service with intent to sell.

Announcement

- ***inform/report*** the readers about new circumstances, asking them to act accordingly. Not an intent to sell. Such as: “Diabetes association is organizing an excursion to X”. → can inform about the price but does not try to attract/intent to sell

Appeal

- **appeal/call** to an action where the action *does not imply inviting to buy something (can be a call for donations though). Usually in letters (e.g., calling members to act with respect to certain initiative) or invitations to become letter friends.*

Argumentative

- ***express opinion*** or viewpoint with intent to persuade the readers (who usually writes: publication's editorial board or a specific author)

Bio

- chronologically ***narrate/report*** one’s own or some person’s biography, experience (most often patient experiences)

Fiction

- ***entertain, distract*** and emotionally engage the reader: novel, short story, poem, humour

Guidance

- ***provide a specific or step-by-step instruction***, advice, recommendation: dietary instructions, manuals, recipes

Informational

- similar to encyclopedia article: factually ***explain*** a phenomenon, not a report about research

Interactive

- ***entertain*** the readers: quizzes, crosswords

Invitation

- A text which ***promotes/invites*** the readers to participate in an event or an action (invitation to a cruise for patients)

Legal

- ***explain*** legal terms and conditions, regulations, etc.

News

- ***inform/report*** on a recent EVENT: **what HAPPENED when and where** in a way daily news report, not in the domain of Patient Organization (PO)

QA

- QA section of the journal in a **QA format**, purpose: ***explain***/***resolve the doubts*** of the patients, provide assistance, may include questions. Rubrics such as “Frågan är fri”

PO_report

- ***narrate/report*** about past patient organization events, meetings, members+**publication-related reports, such as:** “we are launching a new rubric in the X journal...”

▼ Extended Definitions

📎 Academic

Goal: Disseminate original academic research or scholarly analysis. This differs from **Informational** texts, which explain established knowledge, and **Guidance**, which provides advice or instructions. Hybrid texts may occur; if the text is mostly academic, label it **Academic**.
Markers:

1. High density of specialist vocabulary, including domain-specific terms (e.g., *coronary angiography*) and research terminology (e.g., *experiment, survey, method, results, measurement, evaluation*).
2. References to academic publications or citations of experts (e.g., medical doctors, researchers).
3. May include expert opinion presented as interpretation of results (label as opinionated if applicable).
4. Factual, often impersonal description of research processes (e.g., experiments, treatments, chemical reactions) and their outcomes.

Advertisement

Goal: Promote a product or service with the intention of encouraging purchase or use.
Typical authors: companies, service providers (e.g., pharmaceutical companies, resorts, travel agencies).
Markers:

- Promotional language with subjective adjectives/adverbs
- Direct address to the reader (2nd person)
- Often written in the 3rd person but may include persuasive appeals

Typical content: descriptions of products or services emphasizing their benefits (e.g., medication, health products, travel services).

If a text promotes a **free product or service**, it is still considered **Advertisement** if the purpose is promotional (e.g., promoting the benefits of a particular food).
❗ If a text describes a product or service **without subjective language or reader address**, label it **Informational** or **Academic** instead.

Announcement

Goal: Inform readers about new circumstances or upcoming events and prompt them to act accordingly (e.g., register or attend).
Unlike **Advertisement** or **Invitation**, announcements are primarily informational and do not aim to persuade or sell.
Markers:

- Frequent use of 1st person plural (“we”)
- Direct address to readers (2nd person)
- Time and place expressions (dates, locations)
- Common phrases such as: *we inform you, notice, please register, we ask you to, please contact*

Appeal

Goal: Request a specific action from readers, members, or authorities.
Appeals differ from **Announcements** and **Invitations** because they explicitly ask readers to take action rather than simply informing them or promoting an event.
Typical contexts: letters or statements where members request action from other members, organizations, or public authorities.
Examples:

- A request for political or organizational action
- Members asking others to participate in a cause or initiative

Appeals typically **do not involve commercial transactions** and are **not purely informational**.

Argumentative

Goal: Express opinions or viewpoints in order to persuade readers.
Typical authors: editorial boards, columnists, or individual contributors.
Markers:

- Opinionated language
- Evaluative adjectives/adverbs (e.g., *great, awful, unbelievable*)
- Expressions of certainty or doubt (e.g., *certainly, surely, I have no doubt*)
- Often uses 1st person perspective

Argumentative texts present **interpretation, evaluation, or debate** rather than neutral reporting.

Bio

Goal: Narrate the life, experiences, or personal history of an individual.
This genre includes autobiographies, biographies, diaries, and personal experience narratives (often patient stories). Hybrid texts may occur, for example when a biography also expresses opinions.
Markers:

1. First- or third-person narration
2. Chronological structure
3. References to times and locations
4. Primarily factual narration (may contain opinions)
5. Neutral or informal language with limited use of figurative language

Subgenres: autobiography, memoir, travel narrative, personal letter, diary.

Fiction

Goal: Entertain and emotionally engage the reader through storytelling.
Fiction typically presents invented events or characters, although it may resemble personal narratives. When it is unclear whether a story reflects real experiences or fictional ones, **Bio** and **Fiction** may both apply.
Markers:

1. Imaginary characters, events, or settings
2. Creative language and literary devices
3. Emotional engagement and narrative tension
4. Dialogue between characters

Subgenres: poems, short stories, humor, myths, novels, novellas.

Guidance

Goal: Provide advice or step-by-step instructions to help readers achieve a goal or solve a problem (e.g., health, legal, or practical matters).
Typical authors: experts, professionals, or members of the organization (e.g., doctors, dieticians, consultants).
Target audience: readers of the publication or members of the organization.
Markers:

1. Imperative or directive language (*should, must, need to*)
2. Lists of recommended actions
3. Direct address to the reader
4. Sequential or chronological structure
5. Phrases such as *it is recommended*, *we advise*, *it is advisable*

Subgenres: dietary advice, exercise instructions, recipes, procedural instructions, application guidelines.

Informational

Goal: Provide factual explanations about a concept, phenomenon, or topic.
Informational texts resemble **encyclopedia entries** and present established knowledge rather than new research.
Markers:

- Neutral and objective tone
- Minimal evaluative language
- Definitions or explanations (e.g., *X is...*, *X occurs when...*)

A useful test: **Would this text fit in a Wikipedia article?**
Informational texts may occasionally include minor argumentative elements; in such cases mark them as **opinionated** if necessary.

Interactive

Goal: Engage readers through participatory content.
Examples: quizzes, crosswords, puzzles, and their solutions.
This genre is rare and may not appear in the training data.

Invitation

Goal: Invite readers to participate in an event or activity.
Unlike **Announcements**, invitations typically highlight the attractiveness or benefits of participation.
Examples: invitations to cruises, markets, or social events.

Legal

Goal: Explain legal rules, regulations, or terms and conditions.
Legal refers to the **function of explaining regulations**, not simply the topic. For example, a news report about a court case is **News**, not **Legal**.
Examples:

- Summaries of regulations
- Legal guidelines or requirements

News

Goal: Report on a recent event.
News texts focus on **what happened, where, and when**, similar to journalistic reporting.
Markers:

- Reporting of recent events
- References to external sources (*X reports that...*, *X announced...*)
- Often outside the specific domain of the patient organization

Reports about **future events** may also be labeled News if they follow a journalistic reporting style.

QA

Goal: Answer readers' questions and provide assistance.
Often appears in dedicated **Q&A sections** of a journal.
Markers:

- Explicit questions and answers
- Reader inquiries (e.g., "Frågan är fri")
- Explanatory responses by experts or editors

PO_report

Goal: Report on activities, plans, or internal matters of a **patient organization (PO)**.
Typical authors: members or leadership of the organization.
Target audience: organization members, related authorities, or stakeholders.
Markers:

1. References to the organization and its leadership
2. Terms such as *annual meeting*, *financial report*, *association activities*

3. Detailed descriptions of events, decisions, or actions involving multiple participants

Subgenres: meeting minutes, financial reports, annual reports, editorial updates, official correspondence.

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7. Edge Cases & FAQs

Q: Are the addresses and keywords in the context of advertisements also regarded as Advertisement?*A:* Yes. If you clearly associate the address or keyword (e.g., *ASTHMA - ALLERGIE - ATEMWEGE*) with a specific ad, it should be annotated as `Advertisement`.

Q: Should I assign references/bibliography the same genre as the text they belong to?*A:* Yes. Assign the same genre if these references are associated with the main text (most common in `Academic`). Also, please type "bibliography" in the comments column.

Q: What if an Advertisement promotes a *free* product?*A:* It is still `Advertisement`. If the author writes positively about a good/service and it reads like a promotion, it is an ad. However, if the text describes a product neutrally without addressing the reader, it is `Informational` or `Academic`.

Q: How do I distinguish Fiction from Bio?*A:* Confusion may arise when it is not clear if a story is a faithful depiction of someone's life (`Bio`) or invented (`Fiction`). Fiction usually aims to entertain using embellishments, humour, or mood-setting scenes, which are unlikely in Bios. If truly ambiguous, you can use the comment section to mark it as a hybrid.

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8. Examples Reference

> **Academic**
> “Diabetics have a lack of insulin. This can firstly be caused by a reduced production of insulin. But there is a second possibility... Normally, the sugar-lowering and sugar-increasing hormones are in balance.”
> “During the rounds, the ward doctor introduces me to a diabetic: "Mrs. N. is 55 years old... Her daily blood sugar peaked at more than 200 mg%, and her urine

sugar excreted at 30 g in 24 hours. We are therefore considering whether additional biguanide tablets should be given...”

Announcement
“The Greater Stockholm Diabetes Association organizes summer farm activities on Barnens Ö in the Stockholm archipelago. The summer activities run for the first period 12 June—6 July... Information and notification no later than March 31.”
Note: Informs about prices but does not advertise/persuade.

Appeal
“So I would like to have pen pals all over Sweden. Would like to exchange letters with girls and boys between 15-20 years old. I myself am 18 years old with diabetes.”
“Låt oss tillsammans stötta forskningen för ett smärtfritt liv! Genom att bidra med en gåva... Sätt in din gåva på PG 90 09 02 – varje krona räknas!”

Bio
“I am an 18-year-old guy who got diabetes in May 1976. I had a cold, the illness came on Saturday and Sunday, you drank a lot and didn't sleep at night... I have been in the hospital twice this year, partly to learn how to take injections...”

Invitation
“Invitation to travel to Helgoland and more with HADAG! Dear friends of the sea and relaxation, we are pleased to invite you on an unforgettable trip... Come on board and be enchanted by the beauty of the North Sea and the Elbe.”

News
“Combating the bilharzia pathogens is particularly urgent in Egypt: 70 percent of the rural population is infected with the worms. The expansion of irrigation systems... has caused bilharzia to spread unexpectedly. With the support of the federal government, the snails are now being chemically exterminated...”

Argumentative
“During such a discussion, the diabetic woman can learn that before the introduction of insulin, a full-term pregnancy was a real rarity... In that conscious and determined sentence "I want my child" is already contained that

> healthy willingness to take a risk... How shocking, for example, is the statistical experience of a gynaecological clinic..."

> **Informational**
> "In addition to this task of storing sugar, insulin has another task, namely that of burning sugar, of converting blood sugar into energy... He first discussed the normal metabolic processes and showed how the sugar in food passes through the digestive tract into the blood and the portal vein."

> **PO_report**
> "ASSOCIATIONS AND BOARDS. National Association for Diabetes (Board in Gothenburg). Ord. Art dealer Pelle Börjesson... The addresses of the local associations and their presidents..."
> "This year, the association's efforts to establish its own children's colony have been crowned with success. On July 4, 27 children traveled to Hälsingland to spend 6 weeks enjoying the great outdoors..."

> **Legal**
> "The result would be better if the medical costs were included in the business expenses... The Federal Fiscal Court dealt with this in a ruling that was printed in volume 74 of the decisions of the Federal Fiscal Court, page 632 ff... In concrete terms, this means that the illness must be a typical occupational illness, the occurrence of which is essentially due to the profession."

Communicative purpose